

The Core Philosophy

90% of fantasy managers make the same mistake: they pick the most famous players. Mbappé, Messi, Ronaldo, Neymar. But fame doesn't equal fantasy points. The player who plays all 7 games in a team that attacks relentlessly, scoring 5+ goals, is worth more than a superstar who gets rested, injured, or plays in a team that wins 1-0 every game.

Our strategy: balance 2-3 premium attackers with value midfielders and defenders from teams likely to dominate their groups. Maximize captain choices. Strategically use transfers at the right time.

Part 1: Premium Picks (Pay Full Price)

Player	Position	Team	Why Buy	Price Tier
Kylian Mbappé	FWD	France	Top scorer favourite. France attack constantly.	Only 6 games guaranteed.
Pedro	FWD	Portugal	Most underrated striker in the world. 0.8 G/A ratio.	Same price for Barca.
Vinicius Jr	MID/FWD	Brazil	Best winger alive when fit. Brazil will dominate groups.	Same price.
Bruno Fernandes	MID	Portugal	Creator + taker. 15+ assists per season.	Same price.
Lautaro Martínez	FWD	Argentina	Proven tournament scorer. Argentina always progresses deep.	Same price.

Beat your league with data-driven picks and captain strategy

Part 2: Value Picks (Budget Savers — High Points, Low Cost)

These are the players that win fantasy leagues. Nobody picks them because they're not famous. But they play every minute and rack up points.

Player	Country	Why They Score Big	Pick Them If
Ferran Torres	Spain	Spain dominate groups, Torres starts when Monaco is up	Spain Monacogroup
Teun Koopmeiners	Netherlands	Box-to-box goals, Netherlands attack relentlessly	Always
Noni Madueke	England	England will rotate — Madueke can start England vs gasier opps	England vs gasier opps
Folarin Balogun	USA	USA need goals. Balogun (Monaco) is the USA strike upstage	USA strike upstage
Christian Pulisic	USA	USA captain, all minutes guaranteed, will always be the crowd	Always
Rúben Neves	Portugal	Defensive mid who bombs forward. Portugal play great cheap.	Portugal play great cheap.

Part 3: Captain Strategy — The Game Within the Game

Captain = double points. Wrong captain and you lose the week. Here's how to play it:

Group Stage Gameweek 1: Pick captain from a team vs weakest opponent. Mbappé vs Group E 4th seed, not Argentina vs Brazil.

Group Stage GW 2-3: Rotate to best fixture. If England play San Marino equivalent, Bellingham is captain regardless of form.

Round of 32/16: Premium captain — Mbappé, Vinicius, Pedro. These are the biggest matches, stars elevate.

Quarter-Finals: Safest reliable scorer. Lautaro Martínez tends to score in pressure knockouts.

Semi-Finals: Go premium. Mbappé in a semi-final with France's squad quality = almost certain involvement.

Part 4: The Avoid List ■

■ **Lionel Messi (if 38+)** — At 38, Messi will likely be rested in group games. Missing his peak form.

■ **Cristiano Ronaldo (if selected)** — Past his prime. Portugal are better without him leading the line.

■ **Neymar** — Injury history makes him high-risk over a 6-week tournament.

■ **Players from Spain/Italy in group stage** — These teams win 1-0. Defensive team = fewer fantasy points.

■ **Expensive goalkeepers** — Keeper points are capped. Spend budget on attackers instead.